

Max Kapustin

CONTACT INFORMATION	Martha Van Rensselaer Hall Ithaca, NY 14853	kapustin@cornell.edu maxkapustin.com
EMPLOYMENT	Assistant Professor , Economics & Brooks School of Public Policy, Cornell University Assistant Professor , Policy Analysis and Management, Cornell University Senior Research Director , Crime Lab and Education Lab, University of Chicago	2021– 2020–2021 2016–2020
PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS	Faculty Research Fellow , National Bureau of Economic Research Affiliate , J-PAL Affiliate , Crime and Justice Policy Lab, University of Pennsylvania Affiliate , Crime Lab and Education Lab, University of Chicago Faculty Affiliate , Cornell Population Center, Cornell University	2024– 2024– 2023– 2020– 2020–
EDUCATION	Ph.D. Economics , University of Michigan B.S. in Finance & Actuarial Science , New York University	2016 2007
RESEARCH	<i>Publications</i> 1. “Machine Learning Can Predict Shooting Victimization Well Enough to Help Prevent It” (with Sara B. Heller, Benjamin Jakubowski, and Zubin Jelveh). <i>The Review of Economics and Statistics</i>, 108(4): 881-896. July 2026. 2. “Employment and Earnings of Men at High Risk of Gun Violence” (with Monica P. Bhatt, Sara B. Heller, Marianne Bertrand, and Chris Blattman). <i>AEA Papers and Proceedings</i>, 114: 58-64. May 2024. 3. “Predicting and Preventing Gun Violence: An Experimental Evaluation of READI Chicago” (with Monica P. Bhatt, Sara B. Heller, Marianne Bertrand, and Chris Blattman). <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>, 139(1): 1-56. February 2024. 4. “Housing Voucher Take-Up and Labor Market Impacts” (with Eric Chyn and Joshua Hyman), <i>Journal of Policy Analysis and Management</i>, 38(1): 65-98. Winter 2019. 5. “The Impact of Housing Assistance on Child Outcomes: Evidence from a Randomized Housing Lottery” (with Brian A. Jacob and Jens Ludwig), <i>Quarterly Journal of Economics</i>, 130(1): 465-506. February 2015. <i>Working Papers</i> 1. “Reducing Gun Violence at Scale” (with Aaron Chalfin, Jeremy Biddle, Brian A. Wade, Natasha Khade, Cristina Layana, Ben Struhl, and Anthony A. Braga). 2026. NBER Working Paper 35292. Ungated copy. 2. “Policing and Management” (with Terrence D. Neumann and Jens Ludwig). 2022. NBER Working Paper 29851. Ungated copy. <i>In Progress</i> 1. “Improving Fatherhood Outcomes for Non-Resident Fathers” (with Isaac Ahuvia, Rachael Maguire, and Steve Raphael) 2. “Providing Intensive Wraparound Supports for Disengaged Chicago Youth: A Randomized Evaluation” (with Nour Abdul-Razzak, Brandon Domash, and Max Lubell)	

3. “Improving Police Performance: An Experimental Evaluation of the Policing Leadership Academy” (with Dylan Fitzpatrick, Aaron Chalfin, Kailey White, and Anthony A. Braga)
4. Long-term follow-up of READI Chicago, including crime and health outcomes (with Monica P. Bhatt, Sara B. Heller, Marianne Bertrand, and Chris Blattman)

SELECTED
RESEARCH
DISSEMINATION

“Focused Deterrence: A Strategy for Reducing Homicides in American Cities” (with Aaron Chalfin). *Economics, Applied*. July 8, 2026 (podcast). <https://www.hoover.org/research/focused-deterrence-strategy-reducing-homicides-american-cities>

“Do the Police Have a Management Problem?” (podcast). *Freakonomics Radio*. December 6, 2023. <https://freakonomics.com/podcast/do-the-police-have-a-management-problem/>

“Police Management Matters a Lot” (with Kenneth Corey and Jens Ludwig). *Vital City*. July 31, 2023. <https://www.vitalcitynyc.org/articles/police-management-matters-a-lot>

Probable Causation (podcast). February 28, 2023. <https://www.probablecausation.com/podcasts/episode-88-sara-heller-and-max-kapustin>

“Gun Violence in the U.S.” (with Sara B. Heller). *EconoFact*. November 14, 2022 (article). <https://econofact.org/gun-violence-in-the-u-s>. December 4, 2022 (podcast). <https://econofact.org/podcast/gun-violence-in-the-united-states>

“Getting more out of policing in the US” (with Jens Ludwig and Terrence Neumann). *VoxEU*. May 7, 2022. <https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/getting-more-out-policing-us>

Media coverage: *The Atlantic*, *Chicago Sun-Times*, *Chicago Tribune*, *The Hill*, *The New York Times*, *New York Magazine*, *NBC News*, *PolitiFact*, *Reuters*, *WBEZ Chicago*

PROFESSIONAL
SERVICE

Reviewer: National Science Foundation

Referee: *American Economic Journal: Applied Economics*, *American Economic Journal: Policy*, *American Economic Review*, *American Journal of Public Health*, *American Law and Economics Review*, *Economic Journal*, *International Review of Law & Economics*, *Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization*, *Journal of Human Resources*, *Journal of Policy Analysis and Management*, *Journal of Public Economics*, *Journal of Urban Economics*, *Journal of Urban Health*, *Quarterly Journal of Economics*, *Review of Economics and Statistics*, *Regional Science and Urban Economics*, *Science Advances*

EXTERNAL
GRANTS

Arnold Ventures (\$2,450,666) 2026 – 2031

Project Title: “Reducing Violent Crime through Improved Police Performance: An Experimental Evaluation of the Policing Leadership Academy.”

Principal Investigators: Anthony A. Braga, Aaron Chalfin, Dylan Fitzpatrick, Max Kapustin, and Kailey White

J-PAL North America Initiative for Effective US Crime Policy (\$290,984) 2026 – 2029

Project Title: “Reducing Violent Crime through Improved Police Performance: An Experimental Evaluation of the Policing Leadership Academy.”

Principal Investigators: Anthony A. Braga, Aaron Chalfin, Dylan Fitzpatrick, Max Kapustin, and Kailey White

- Arnold Ventures (\$94,813) 2025 – 2026
Project Title: “Reducing Gun Violence Without Exacerbating the Harms of Policing? The Group Violence Reduction Strategy in Baltimore.”
Principal Investigators: Anthony A. Braga, Aaron Chalfin, Max Kapustin, and Brian A. Wade
- J-PAL North America Social Policy Research Initiative (\$97,518) 2025 – 2026
Project Title: “Reducing Violent Crime through Improved Police Performance: An Experimental Evaluation of the Policing Leadership Academy.”
Principal Investigators: Anthony A. Braga, Aaron Chalfin, Dylan Fitzpatrick, Max Kapustin, and Kailey White
- Arnold Ventures (\$287,780) 2024 – 2027
Project Title: “Long-Term and Health Impacts of Violence Prevention Programs: Evidence from READI Chicago.”
Principal Investigators: Marianne Bertrand, Monica P. Bhatt, Chris Blattman, Sara B. Heller, and Max Kapustin
- NIH/National Institute on Minority Health and Health Disparities (\$1,867,461) 2021 – 2024
Award: R01MD017194
Project Title: “The Efficacy of Combining Cognitive Behavioral Therapy and Supported Employment as a Violence Prevention Strategy: An Evaluation of READI Chicago.”
Principal Investigators: Marianne Bertrand, Monica P. Bhatt, Chris Blattman, Sara B. Heller, and Max Kapustin
- The Laura and John Arnold Foundation (\$987,634) 2018 – 2022
Project Title: “The Efficacy of Combining Cognitive Behavioral Therapy and Supported Employment as a Violence Prevention Strategy: An Evaluation of READI Chicago.”
Principal Investigators: Marianne Bertrand, Monica P. Bhatt, Chris Blattman, Sara B. Heller, and Max Kapustin
- The Laura and John Arnold Foundation (\$281,776) 2019 – 2022
Project Title: “Providing Intensive Wraparound Supports for Disengaged Chicago Youth: A Randomized Evaluation.”
Principal Investigators: Max Kapustin and Nour Abdul-Razzak
- Institute for Research on Poverty, University of Wisconsin-Madison (\$91,262) 2019 – 2020
Project Title: “Reducing Gun Violence through Precision Policing: An evaluation of the Chicago Police Department’s Strategic Decision Support Centers.”
Principal Investigators: Max Kapustin, Jens Ludwig, and Terrence Neumann

TEACHING
EXPERIENCE

Economics of Crime (2020-26)
Causal Inference and Data Analysis for Public Policy (2020-26)